

KRESTON ALBANIA – INTERNAL SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT PROJECT

Request for Proposal for IT Development Team

Timeframe: *Please submit your proposal within 28/10/2025*

Subject: Design and Development of an Internal Workflow & CRM System

1. Introduction

Kreston Albania is a leading professional services firm, part of the international network **Kreston Global**, providing integrated services in **Audit & Assurance, Tax & Accounting, Legal Advisory, Business Advisory, and HR & Payroll Management**.

To enhance efficiency, internal coordination, and service quality, Kreston Albania seeks to **develop a proprietary internal system** (working title: *Kreston Internal CRM & Workflow Platform*). The system will coordinate all firm operations across departments and within each department, streamline communication, and generate actionable performance insights.

The IT provider is invited to review the following requirements and submit a detailed proposal including methodology, implementation plan, estimated cost, maintenance terms, and timeline.

2. Project Objectives

The system aims to:

- Create a **centralized platform** where every employee logs in according to their role and department.
- Enable **hierarchical visibility**, so users can oversee work performed by levels below them (e.g., Partner → Manager → Senior → Associate → Junior → Assistant → Intern). A detailed organogram with intermediary roles will be provided upon agreement.
- Integrate with Kreston Albania's existing software ecosystem (e.g., **Caseware, Financa 5**, other industry-specific software, and Microsoft tools like Outlook, Teams, Excel, and Word). This feature will be subject to future updates, as Kreston Albania regularly implements the use of various technologies which are directly connected to providing our services.

- Provide **clear dashboards** and **automated reports** to improve performance, accountability, and collaboration.
- Serve as the technological foundation for a **Phase 2 client portal and mobile app**, allowing clients to access deliverables and track service progress.

3. System Scope and Architecture

The proposed system will include **modular components** that share a unified structure and database.

Modules will include:

1. **Dashboard & Reporting Layer**
2. **Department Modules which are also the main services we provide:**
 - o Audit & Advisory
 - o Accounting & Tax
 - o Bookkeeping & Payroll
 - o Legal Advisory
 - o Advisory Services
3. **HR Module** (for internal HR management and outsourced HR clients)
4. **Marketing Module**
5. **Kreston Global (Network) Module**
6. **Client Portal** (*Phase 2*)
7. **Mobile App / Dashboard App** (*Phase 2*)

The system will be **hosted internally** on Kreston Albania's servers and primarily accessed via desktop in Phase 1.

4. Functional Requirements

4.1 User and Role Management

- Unique login for each user with credentials and permissions tied to position.
- Role-based visibility: managers and partners can view subordinate workflows.

- Hierarchical access structure matching Kreston's organigram.
- Audit trail for user actions.
- Role addition/modification flexibility. Different roles can cooperate to perform a task/service.
- Optional integration with **Microsoft Azure Active Directory** for single sign-on.

4.2 Departmental Modules

Each department module should share a unified logic and interface, customized to its specific workflow for which we will provide the specific tasks per role, as well as grouped per service provided.

Core Functions per Department:

- Task creation and assignment with deadlines and progress status.
- Workflow chains (e.g., preparation → review → approval → completion).
- Department dashboard showing work in progress, backlog, KPIs.
- API integration with department software (e.g., Caseware, Financa 5, etc).
- Excel import/export for ongoing or historical projects.
- Document management and version control.
- Alerts and notifications for overdue or pending items.
- Reporting by task, employee, or client.

*The primary objective is to ensure the system is highly user-friendly and does **not** create additional administrative work for employees. Process automation is therefore essential, the system must significantly minimize, if not eliminate, the need for manual data entry.*

Additionally, the system should enable complete visibility of the client journey within the firm — from the first contact and proposal stage, through contract signing, to the delivery of services and execution of tasks. It should maintain a clear record of all activities and communications linked to each client, generate reminders for contract renewals or terminations, and facilitate timely follow-ups. This holistic view will help teams coordinate efficiently, improve client experience, and support data-driven management decisions.

4.3 HR Module

Internal HR:

- Employee master data, role, department, salary band (restricted view).
- Leave management, approvals, and absence calendar.
- Performance review dashboard connected to task data.
- Training and certification tracking.

Client HR Outsourcing:

- Ability to manage multiple client HR datasets securely.
- Service-level metrics (e.g., number of employees managed, requests completed).
- Separate or limited-access client view (optional in Phase 1; core in Phase 2).

4.4 Marketing Module

- Campaign tracking (budget, team, duration, outcome).
- Task scheduling and progress monitoring.
- Asset/document library (graphics, texts, reports).
- Dashboard summarizing leads, conversions, ROI (data may be manually entered).
- Integration with Outlook/Teams for communication and approvals.

4.5 Kreston Global Module

- Repository for materials, updates, and opportunities from the global network.
- Search and categorization of resources.
- Internal sharing and linking to engagements.

4.6 Business Development Module

The Business Development (BD) Module will serve as the firm's centralized sales and client relationship management hub, integrating with other operational modules to provide a 360° view of every client and prospect.

Core Features:

- **Lead & Prospect Management:** Track all potential clients from initial contact to proposal submission and contract signing.
- **Proposal Tracking:** Record proposal details, responsible staff, submission dates, approval status, and conversion outcomes.
- **Client Onboarding Workflow:** Once a contract is signed, automatically trigger the onboarding process and handover to the relevant department.
- **Client History Overview:** Unified client record showing the entire lifecycle — from acquisition to ongoing services and renewals.
- **Contract Management:** Store signed contracts, record start and end dates, and generate automated **reminders for expiration or renewal**.
- **Follow-up Scheduler:** Automated notifications for follow-up actions, check-ins, and resigning discussions.
- **Integration with Outlook & Teams:** Synchronize emails, meeting notes, and follow-up tasks to maintain a complete interaction history.
- **Reporting & Analytics:** KPIs such as lead-to-client conversion rate, average proposal turnaround time, renewal ratio, and pipeline value.
- **Visibility:** Managers and Partners can oversee pipelines across departments and team members.
- **Integration:**
 - With **Marketing Module** (for lead generation sources).
 - With **HR & Department Modules** (to assign relationship managers and delivery teams).
 - With **Client Portal** (Phase 2) to display ongoing engagement history to clients if desired.

4.6 Internal Finance Module

The Internal Finance Module will function as the firm's internal accounting and financial control system. It is not client-facing but focused on budgeting, expense management, profitability tracking, and performance reporting for Kreston Albania itself.

Core Features:

- **Budget Planning & Monitoring:** Define annual budgets by department, project, or service line; compare actuals vs. forecasts.
- **Expense Tracking:** Record firm expenses (office, travel, HR, marketing, etc.) and assign them to departments or projects.
- **Revenue Monitoring:** Import revenue and billing data from existing accounting systems (e.g., Financa 5) to display real-time cash flow summaries.
- **Project Profitability Analysis:** Link data from departmental modules (e.g., hours logged, staff utilisation, service costs) to assess margins by engagement.
- **Approval Workflow:** Digital approval chain for expense claims, supplier invoices, and internal transfers, respecting hierarchy.
- **Integration with Financa 5:** Pull general ledger entries, invoices, and reconciled balances automatically.
- **Dashboard:** KPIs such as departmental budget utilisation, total firm revenue, outstanding receivables, and cost-to-income ratios.
- **Reporting:** Generate financial statements (P&L, cash-flow, cost-centre summaries) for Partners and management.
- **Alerts & Reminders:** Automatic notifications for budget overruns, pending invoice approvals, and upcoming tax/payment deadlines.
- **Security & Access:** Restricted visibility (Partner and Internal Finance staff only) with export capabilities for reporting to management.

Integration Points:

- **With Departmental Modules** – to allocate costs and assess profitability by service line.
- **With HR Module** – to link payroll data and track HR-related costs.
- **With Business Development Module** – to project revenue pipelines and monitor realised vs. forecasted income.

- **With Dashboard Layer** – to aggregate financial KPIs for leadership review.

4.7 Dashboard & Reporting Layer

- Firm-wide view with drill-down by department and user.
- KPIs: task completion rate, utilisation, backlog, profitability, client overview.
- Export to Excel/Word/PDF.
- Weekly or monthly automated summaries (via Outlook or Teams).

4.8 Client Portal (Phase 2)

- Client login to view project status, upload/download documents, and communicate with assigned teams.
- Two-way messaging and task tracking.
- Visual progress tracker per service (audit, payroll, etc.).
- Secure data segregation per client.

4.9 Mobile App / Dashboard App (Phase 2)

- Mobile view of dashboards and tasks.
- Push notifications for approvals, deadlines, or updates.

5. Integrations and Compatibility

- **Caseware API Integration:** to extract job and engagement data for Audit & Advisory.
- **Financa 5 API Integration:** to import accounting/tax job data.
- **Microsoft 365 Integration:**
 - Outlook (emails, calendar alerts)
 - Teams (notifications, task mentions)
 - Excel/Word (import/export documents and templates)

- **Data Import:** legacy Excel spreadsheets for initial population and periodic updates.
- Other industry specific software which we will provide upon agreement

6. Technical Requirements

- **Hosting:** on Kreston Albania's internal servers (IT vendor to specify specs).
- **Access:** via internal secure network (intranet or VPN).
- **Scalability:** accommodate up to 70 users and growing datasets.
- **Security:**
 - Role-based access controls
 - Data encryption in transit and at rest
 - Daily backups and versioning
 - GDPR-compliant data management
- **Architecture:** preferably web-based application with modular structure (frontend/backend separation).
- **Usability:** intuitive, consistent interface with minimal training required.
- **Audit Logs:** all user actions and document updates traceable.
- **Maintenance:** clear update, patching, and support plan.

7. Proposal Requirements from the IT Team

Please include in your proposal:

1. **Methodology:** development approach.
2. **Technology stack:** frameworks, languages, databases proposed.
3. **Timeline:** milestones, testing phases, go-live target.
4. **Deliverables:** per phase, including documentation and training.
5. **Pricing:**
 - Design & development cost (Phase 1)

- o Phase 2 cost estimate (portal + app)
- o Maintenance plan & cost (monthly/annual)
- 6. **Team composition:** roles and responsibilities (project manager, developers, QA, support).
- 7. **Server & infrastructure recommendations:** minimum specs, backup protocols, data recovery plan.
- 8. **Security & data protection plan.**
- 9. **Training plan** for administrators and users.
- 10. **Warranty period** for post-go-live bug fixes.
- 11. **Support SLAs:** response time, escalation process, contact methods.
- 12. **References or relevant case studies.**

8. Additional Notes

- The system should allow **future AI-based analytics**, such as workload prediction and performance optimisation.
- User adoption is key: simplicity, intuitive dashboards, and integration with current software used, are essential.
- *The vendor should propose **change management and training support** to ensure smooth internal rollout.*

Final Note – Collaboration with Existing IT Provider

Kreston Albania currently collaborates with a dedicated IT company that manages our day-to-day technology infrastructure, including network security, server maintenance, and user support. The selected development team will therefore be expected to **work in close coordination** with our existing IT provider to ensure cohesive integration, data security, and infrastructure compatibility throughout all project phases.

In your proposal, please outline how you envision **collaboration and responsibility sharing** between your team and our internal IT partner — including communication channels, technical access, and maintenance responsibilities — to guarantee a smooth, secure, and sustainable implementation as well as future maintenance needs.